

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:56

Hide

Annotate  More 

Rembrandt Harmenszoon van Rijn, an eminent Dutch artist, is renowned for his profound ability to capture human emotion in his art. His work made him a _____ figure in the realm of fine arts. His work, characterized by intricate detail and dramatic use of light and darkness, evokes a sense of depth and realism that was unprecedented for his time. Rembrandt's influence on the art world extended beyond his lifetime, inspiring generations of artists and establishing him as one of the greatest painters in European art history.

1

 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: seminal



B: improbable



C: malleable



D: fleeting



Question 1 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:50

Hide

Annotate  More 

Ricardo Miro, considered the national poet of Panama, holds a distinct position in the country's literary history. His influence is _____ throughout his extensive body of work, which spans various themes. Miro's poetry, imbued with a deep sense of patriotism and an acute awareness of social issues, has shaped the national identity of Panama. His seminal work, *Patria*, is lauded as a literary masterpiece, encapsulating the spirit of the Panamanian people and their struggles. Miro's contributions to Panamanian literature have been instrumental in fostering a rich literary culture in the nation.

2  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: sporadic



B: negligible



C: inconsistent



D: pervasive



Question 2 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Photovoltaic engineering, the discipline that focuses on converting light into electricity, is a rapidly evolving field. It is characterized by the continuous introduction of innovative materials and technologies aimed at enhancing energy conversion efficiency. The success of photovoltaic systems is contingent upon their capacity to absorb and convert sunlight into usable power. The light absorbance of these systems is influenced by the _____ properties of the materials used, making the selection of these materials a crucial aspect of photovoltaic engineering.

3 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: optical



B: acoustic



C: thermal



D: temporal



Question 3 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:35

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from J.M. Barrie's 1911 novel *Peter Pan*. The Darling children are flying with Peter Pan and Tinker Bell, making their way to Neverland.

The children had brought two of their numerous pets, a Newfoundland dog and a roly-poly pudding. The idea was that they could all fly home for tea, and then fly back to Neverland to sleep. It had been a happy day and a pleasant flight. They were not lonely, for they had all the world below them to watch over and speculate. Tinker Bell had been asleep on Peter's shoulder, but now she woke up and was looking round for mischief.

4  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the primary purpose of the text?

A: To highlight the mischievous nature of Tinker Bell, as she wakes up looking for trouble.



B: To emphasize the unique bond between the children and their pets, who they brought on their journey.



C: To portray the adventurous spirit of Peter Pan, who had the idea of flying back and forth for tea.



D: To convey the sense of joy and wonder the Darling children are experiencing during their flight to Neverland.



Question 4 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:27

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Frances Hodgson Burnett's 1911 novel 'The Secret Garden.' Mary, a young girl, has discovered a hidden garden and has been secretly tending to it.

It was the sweetest, most mysterious-looking place anyone could imagine. The high walls which shut it in were covered with the leafless stems of roses which were so thick, that they matted together. 'They are like a curtain of beautiful tangled branches,' said Mary. There were other trees in the garden, and one of the things which made the place look strangest and loveliest was that climbing roses had run all over them and swung down long tendrils which made light swaying curtains.

5  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To highlight Mary's excitement and curiosity about the newly discovered garden



B: To describe the enchanting and unusual beauty of the secret garden Mary has found



C: To emphasize the difficulty of gardening due to the beautiful but tangled branches



D: To depict the isolation of the secret garden from the outside world due to the high walls



Question 5 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

The following text is adapted from Charles Dickens's *Bleak House*. A young woman named Esther Summerson describes her feelings about the city.

"I have grown accustomed to the grandeur of the city, but not to the mire and dirt. I think of it as a distant place where people are busiest who have the least purpose or enjoyment and where the tired workers, who seem to my mind to have been born tired, are 'going home' to such a home as I have had in my childhood."

6 Mark for Review

Which choice best encapsulates the central theme of the passage?

A: Esther Summerson's struggle to adapt to the grandeur and dirt of the city and coming and going home.

B: Esther Summerson's perception of the city as a place of purposeless activity and tired workers.

C: Esther Summerson's pity for the tired workers who seem to have been born tired and always busy.

D: Esther Summerson's critique of the city as a place of disheartening contradiction between grandeur and misery.

Question 6 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:11

Hide

Annotate  More 

Text 1

Albert Bierstadt, a member of the Hudson River School, was known for his astounding landscapes. His work was considered significant as it captured the raw, untamed beauty of the American West. Bierstadt's paintings became a representation of the American identity, with his depictions of the frontier symbolizing the country's potential for growth and prosperity.

Text 2

Art historian Julia Friedman argues that Bierstadt's work goes beyond just depicting the American landscape. According to her, his paintings are a visual commentary on the socio-political climate of the time. His depictions of the frontier, she asserts, carry symbolic meanings, reflecting the federal government's policies and the popular sentiment towards westward expansion.

7  Mark for Review

Based on the texts, how would Julia Friedman (Text 2) most likely respond to the "significance" of Bierstadt's work discussed in Text 1?

A: By agreeing that Bierstadt's work is significant but claiming that it is only due to his artistic skill and not any deeper meaning.



B: By contesting the belief that Bierstadt's paintings symbolize the country's potential for growth and prosperity.



C: By expanding on it, asserting that his work not only captures the American landscape but also provides a commentary on the socio-political climate.



D: By discounting the significance of Bierstadt's paintings, arguing that they do not offer any meaningful insight into the American identity.



Question 7 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:04

Hide

Annotate  More 

In twilight realms where shadows merge with light,
A silent symphony plays in the night;
Each star a note in an endless score,
Whispers of cosmos from ancient lore.

In verdant fields where time gently treads,
Each petal's hue a story that spreads;
Nature's soft murmurs in the breeze,
A tapestry of life that none can seize.

Through these verses, a journey we take,
In every line, a world to awake;
Poetry's power, in essence, is to bind
The heart and soul, the cosmos and mind.

8  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the main purpose of the text?

A: To evoke a sense of wonder and connection between the natural world and human experience.

B: To provide a detailed scientific exploration of the universe and natural world and human experience.

C: To offer a historical perspective on human interaction with nature and the cosmos

D: To serve as a critique of modern society's disconnection from the natural world

Question 8 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:58

Hide

Annotate  More 

In J.R.R. Tolkien's 'The Lord of the Rings', the character of Frodo Baggins evolves significantly throughout his journey. Initially depicted as an unassuming hobbit, Frodo is thrust into a world of immense challenge and peril when he inherits the One Ring. His transformation is marked by moments of courage, despair, and insight. A clear illustration of his transformation is evident when he _____. This pivotal moment is contrasted against his earlier hesitation and the relative comfort of his life in the Shire, highlighting the depth of his personal growth and the weight of his newfound responsibility.

9  Mark for Review

Which choice most effectively uses a quotation from 'The Lord of the Rings' to illustrate the claim?

A: remarks to Sam, 'It's the job that's never started as takes longest to finish.'



B: states, 'I wish it need not have happened in my time.'



C: declares in a moment of realization, 'I will take the Ring, though I do not know the way.'



D: reflects, 'The world is indeed full of peril, and in it there are many dark places.'



Question 9 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:38

Hide

Annotate  More 

Remy de Gourmont, a prominent French writer, was widely known for his unique philosophical ideas. He postulated that individualism stemmed from the unique combination of experiences one encounters, rather than being inherent. To support his theory, Gourmont compared individuals with similar backgrounds and found variations in their individualistic tendencies. He proposed that the differences were due to unique experiences rather than innate characteristics. His theory sparked widespread discussions and debates in the philosophical circles of his time.

10  Mark for Review

Which of the following, if true, would most directly undermine Gourmont's theory of individualism?

A: People with similar backgrounds often have similar responses to unique experiences.

B: Individualistic tendencies have been observed to be stronger in certain cultures and societies.

C: Studies have found a significant genetic influence on the development of individualism.

D: There are instances of people who have led very different lives but display similar individualistic tendencies.

Question 10 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:29

Hide

Annotate  More 

In Homer's epic, *The Iliad*, Achilles is presented as the greatest warrior of the Greeks. However, he withdraws from battle after a quarrel with Agamemnon. During his absence, the Trojans, led by Hector, make significant progress. This leads some scholars to argue that Achilles' withdrawal was a strategic move to make the Greeks realize his value. Others suggest it was merely an act of anger. These contrasting interpretations remain a point of debate among scholars studying *The Iliad*.

11  Mark for Review

Which of the following, if true, would most directly undermine the argument that Achilles' withdrawal was a strategic move?

A: Achilles' rage towards Agamemnon is a recurring theme in *The Iliad*.

B: Historical accounts reveal that Achilles was known for his impulsivity and was not a strategic thinker.

C: The Greeks suffered heavy losses during Achilles' absence, leading to further discontent among the ranks.

D: Hector, the Trojan leader, was known to be a strategic thinker and could have anticipated Achilles' withdrawal.

Question 11 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Researcher	Year	Method	Habitat Loss (%)	Food Shortage (%)	Population Decline (%)
Smith et al.	2015	Satellite Imaging	30	25	35
Johnson and Reed	2018	Ground Surveys	40	30	45
Peterson	2020	Drone Surveillance	35	35	40
Miller and Davis	2017	Satellite Imaging	31	25	36

Orangutans, native to the Borneo and Sumatra islands, suffer severe consequences due to rampant deforestation. The impact is measured by analyzing factors such as habitat loss, food shortage, and population decline. Researchers have suggested that the severity of deforestation's effects on orangutans varies, depending on the factors considered and the methodologies applied.

12 Mark for Review

Which choice best describes data from the table that support the researchers' suggestion about the effects of deforestation on orangutans?

A: The studies by Smith et al. and Miller and Davis, both using satellite imaging, produced similar estimates, while Peterson's study using drone surveillance and Johnson and Reed's ground surveys resulted in different estimates.

B: The study by Peterson using drone surveillance resulted in the highest estimated percentage of habitat loss and food shortage.

C: The findings of Johnson and Reed's ground surveys showed a higher percentage of population decline than those of Smith et al.'s satellite imaging.

D: Miller and Davis's study using satellite imaging estimated a slightly higher percentage of habitat loss than Smith et al.'s study using the same method.

Snakes, often misunderstood and feared, are actually pivotal to maintaining ecological balance. They play a critical role as both predators and prey in various ecosystems. By controlling rodent populations, which can be vectors for disease and cause agricultural damage, snakes indirectly protect human health and crop yields. Furthermore, certain snake venoms are being studied for their potential in medical research, holding the promise of groundbreaking treatments. Despite these benefits, global snake populations face significant threats from habitat destruction, climate change, and direct persecution by humans. The declining number of snakes could disrupt ecological equilibrium, yet this issue receives limited attention. Consequently, there is _____.

13  Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: a complete collapse of the ecosystems where they are native, leading to a domino effect on global biodiversity.

B: insufficient actions in the conservation efforts to protect these creatures and the balance they bring to ecosystems.

C: a sudden increase in the populations of other predatory animals due to removal of competition.

D: an immediate end to the development of new life-saving drugs from snake venom as there will be no more snakes left.

Zeno of Citium, the founder of Stoicism, was a philosopher of significant influence in his own time. His teachings have continued to shape modern philosophical thought, particularly in the realm of ethics. Zeno emphasized the importance of virtue, asserting that a good life is one lived in accordance with nature. This view has been adopted by many modern philosophers, who see virtue as the primary source of personal happiness. However, Zeno's philosophy has been the subject of critique as well. Notably, some argue that his emphasis on self-control and emotional detachment can lead to apathy and indifference. Despite these criticisms, the influence of Zeno's philosophy is undeniable, even though it might inadvertently result in _____.

14  Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the ignoring of societal norms which are not in line with nature. 

B: the disregarding of emotional responses as an essential part of human experience. 

C: the creation of an unrealistic expectation for constant happiness. 

D: the overemphasis on individualistic notions of virtue to the detriment of communal values. 

Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:55

Hide

Annotate  More 

The storm raged outside, lightning illuminating the room—revealing the chaos of scattered books and trembling candle flames. In that _____ and awe mingled as the power of nature's fury unfolded before my eyes.

15  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: moment, fear



B: moment—fear



C: moment: fear



D: moment fear



Question 15 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In traditional African societies, the leatherworker played a crucial role. They were responsible for creating a variety of items, such as shoes, bags, and clothing. These items were not only functional but also held cultural significance. The leatherworker's skills were highly valued, and their work was often intricate and detailed. Despite the hard work and dedication, the leatherworker's role was often _____ in the wider society.

16 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: overlooked, undervalued

B: overlooked; undervalued

C: overlooked and undervalued

D: overlooked: undervalued

In the realm of literature, each genre has its unique ____ novels offer suspense and intrigue, while romance explores emotional depth. This diversity enriches the literary world, inviting readers with varied tastes. Mystery engages the reader's detective instincts, and romance delves into the complexities of relationships. Such variety ensures that literature can mirror life's mosaic of experiences, resonating with a wide audience.

17  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: appeal, mystery,



B: appeal mystery



C: appeal, mystery



D: appeal; mystery



Section 1, Module 1:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:37

Hide

Annotate  More 

Melissus of Samos was a prominent pre-Socratic philosopher who proposed several intriguing ideas. He argued that reality is ungenerated, unperishing, and unchanging, asserting that nothing can come into existence from nothing. His philosophical ideas _____ and analyzed by scholars throughout history. Despite the complexity of his thoughts, Melissus's philosophy continues to inspire and challenge thinkers worldwide.

18  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: have been widely discussed

B: has been widely discussed

C: had been widely discussed

D: is being widely discussed

Question 18 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In the heart of the Amazon rainforest, a unique species of butterfly exhibits remarkable color-changing abilities. These butterflies can alter their wing patterns in response to environmental factors, displaying a range of colors that serve various purposes, from attracting mates to deterring predators. The butterfly's ability to change colors is due to specialized cells in the _____ that reflect light differently.

19  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: wings' scales



B: wings scales



C: wing's scales



D: wings scale's



Smart homes are becoming increasingly popular. They offer a variety of benefits, such as energy efficiency and convenience. _____ the temperature based on your preferences, which can save a lot of energy. Additionally, smart homes can provide enhanced security features, such as surveillance cameras and alarm systems. With the advancement of technology, smart homes are expected to become even more sophisticated in the future.

20 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: The system can automatically adjusting

B: The system can automatically adjust

C: The system automatically can adjusted

D: The system automatically can adjusts

In his groundbreaking novel 'Invisible Man', Ralph Ellison explores the complex themes of identity and invisibility in African American life. The protagonist's journey, an allegory of individual and collective identity, is rife with symbolism and introspection. As the narrative unfolds, Ellison delves into the protagonist's psyche, revealing the struggles and realizations that define his existence, making _____ a figure of profound complexity and resonance.

21  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: him



B: they



C: ourselves



D: her



The field of African mammalogy has grown significantly over the past few decades. African researchers have made major contributions to the study of the continent's diverse mammalian species. They have documented new species, studied their behavior, and tracked their migrations. _____ African mammalogists have contributed to global efforts to conserve endangered species and their habitats.

22 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: In addition,

B: In contrast,

C: However,

D: On the other hand,

Question 22 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Sir Charles Sturt, a British explorer of Australia, made significant contributions to the understanding of the continent's interior. He led several expeditions into the arid heart of Australia, mapping vast areas previously unexplored by Europeans. _____ his expeditions provided crucial information about the geography, flora, and fauna of the region.

23 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Contrarily,

B: Nevertheless,

C: On the other hand,

D: Furthermore,

Question 23 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Post-structuralism, a concept that emerged in mid-20th century philosophy, aims to critique and deconstruct the 'structures' that underpin social, cultural and political reality. It rejects the concept of absolute truth and the existence of stable identities. _____ it focuses on the role of language in shaping our understanding of reality.

24 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Likewise,

B: In contrast,

C: In conclusion,

D: Instead,

Question 24 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Water is a compound made up of hydrogen and oxygen.
- The chemical formula for water is H_2O .
- Hydrogen peroxide is another compound that includes hydrogen and oxygen.
- The chemical formula for hydrogen peroxide is H_2O_2 .
- Both water and hydrogen peroxide are used in various industrial and household applications.

25  Mark for Review

The student wants to emphasize a similarity between the two compounds. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: Water, with the chemical formula H_2O , is a widely used compound in various applications. 

B: Hydrogen peroxide (H_2O_2) and water (H_2O) both have household uses. 

C: Both water (H_2O) and hydrogen peroxide (H_2O_2) are compounds made up of hydrogen and oxygen. 

D: The chemical formula for hydrogen peroxide is H_2O_2 , different from water's H_2O . 

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Cleopatra was the last active ruler of the Ptolemaic Kingdom of Egypt.
- She became co-regent with her 10-year-old brother Ptolemy XIII when she was 18.
- Cleopatra sought the support of Julius Caesar, who helped her regain Egypt's throne.
- She later aligned with Mark Antony, with whom she had three children.
- Despite her alliances, Cleopatra's reign ended with the fall of Egypt to Rome, and she committed suicide.

26 Mark for Review

The student wants to write about Cleopatra's political strategy. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: Cleopatra, the last active ruler of the Ptolemaic Kingdom of Egypt, was the mother of three children with Mark Antony.

B: At the age of 18, Cleopatra became co-regent with her 10-year-old brother Ptolemy XIII.

C: Cleopatra's reign ended tragically when she committed suicide after the fall of Egypt to Rome.

D: To maintain her power, Cleopatra formed alliances with powerful Roman leaders like Julius Caesar and Mark Antony.

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The orbits of planets in the solar system are influenced by gravitational interactions.
- Jupiter, being the largest planet, has a significant gravitational pull.
- The asteroid belt lies between Mars and Jupiter.
- The gravitational influence of Jupiter has been hypothesized to shape the structure of the asteroid belt.
- Some asteroids have been ejected from the belt due to Jupiter's gravitational disturbances.

27 Mark for Review

The student wants to make and support a generalization about the influence of planetary gravity on smaller celestial bodies. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish these goals?

A: Planetary gravity, especially from larger planets like Jupiter, plays a crucial role in the formation and maintenance of asteroid belts, as well as in the trajectories of individual asteroids within these belts.



B: The orbits of planets are primarily determined by the sun's gravitational pull, with minimal influence from the gravitational forces of other planets in the solar system



C: Jupiter's position in the solar system prevents the formation of any additional planets between Mars and Jupiter, leading to the existence of the asteroid belt.



D: The asteroid belt's existence between Mars and Jupiter is a coincidence, and planetary gravity has little to no effect on the structure or composition of asteroid belts.



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:54

Hide

Annotate  More 

In the intricate dance of an ecosystem, _____ species play a pivotal role in maintaining ecological equilibrium. Their actions create a cascade of effects that sustain diverse life forms. The sea otter, for instance, exemplifies this role within kelp forest communities, where their predation on sea urchins prevents the overgrazing of kelp beds, thus supporting a myriad of marine species. This delicate balance underscores the interconnectedness of life and the critical importance of preserving such keystone species to ensure the health of our planet's diverse ecosystems.

1  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: keystone



B: peripheral



C: dominant



D: transient



Question 1 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:47

Hide

Annotate  More 

Thomas Edison, one of the most prolific inventors in history, held a unique place in America's development as its foremost innovator. With 1,093 patents to his name, he became an _____ figure in the annals of his nation's history. His inventions, including the phonograph, the motion picture camera, and the practical electric light bulb, revolutionized daily life. Edison's considerable influence was evident not only in his time but continues to impact our lives today. His relentless pursuit of innovation underscored his belief in the power of human ingenuity.

2  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: inextricably



B: combined



C: unified



D: merged



Question 2 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Mark Twain, born as Samuel Clemens, was a ____ figure in American literature, known for his distinctive narrative style that combined humor, satire, and sharp social foresight. His novels, brimming with vibrant characters and intricate plots, are lauded not only as cornerstones of American literature but also as prescient reflections on societal evolution. Twain's works, such as 'The Adventures of Tom Sawyer' and 'Adventures of Huckleberry Finn,' have been extensively studied and analyzed for their uncanny ability to anticipate future social dynamics and challenges. These narratives, characterized by their unique blend of wit and societal insight, underscore Twain's remarkable gift for predicting the trajectory of American culture and social values, cementing his status as one of the most forward-thinking authors of his era.

3  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical and precise word or phrase?

A: prognosticative



B: incontrovertible



C: perennial



D: intransigent



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:32

Hide

Annotate  More 

Excerpt from "To Autumn" by John Keats:

Season of mists and mellow fruitfulness,
Close bosom-friend of the maturing sun;
Conspiring with him how to load and bless
With fruit the vines that round the thatch-eves run;
To bend with apples the moss'd cottage-trees,
And fill all fruit with ripeness to the core;
To swell the gourd, and plump the hazel shells
With a sweet kernel; to set budding more,
And still more, later flowers for the bees,
Until they think warm days will never cease,
For Summer has o'er-brimm'd their clammy cells.

4  Mark for Review

Which choice best states the shift that occurs in these lines from John Keats' "To Autumn"?

A: From a focus on the physical actions of autumn to the emotional effects on the observer.



B: From a description of early autumn's bounty to the anticipation of winter's scarcity.



C: From detailing the abundance of harvest to highlighting the preparations for the coming colder months.



D: From an emphasis on the fruitful collaboration between the season and the sun to the individual experiences of the plants and insects affected by autumn.



Question 4 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:24

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Harper Lee's 1960 novel *To Kill a Mockingbird*. Scout, the novel's young narrator, is speaking about her father, Atticus Finch.

Atticus was feeble: he was nearly fifty. When Jem and I asked him why he was so old, he said he got started late, which we felt reflected upon his abilities and manliness. He was much older than the parents of our school contemporaries, and there was nothing Jem or I could say about him when our classmates said, "My father—"

5  Mark for Review

Which choice best articulates the central theme of this passage from *To Kill a Mockingbird*?

A: The passage is primarily about the difference in age between Atticus and other parents

B: The passage focuses on Jem and Scout's disappointment in their father's age and perceived lack of vigor

C: The passage is about Scout's deep respect and admiration for her father, Atticus

D: The passage is conveying Scout and Jem's struggle to understand and accept their father's advancing age and its perceived implications on his abilities

Question 5 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:17

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Truman Capote's 1958 novella 'Breakfast at Tiffany's.' Holly Golightly, the main character, is described by the narrator.

She was never without dark glasses, she was always well groomed, there was a consequential good taste in the plainness of her clothes, the blues and greys and lack of lustre that made her, herself, shine so. One might have thought her a photographer's model, perhaps a young actress, except that it was obvious, looking at her, that she was not a society girl. She had a special manner.

6

 Mark for Review

Which choice best states the primary purpose of the text?

A: To provide a detailed description of Holly Golightly's physical appearance and suggest her unique personality



B: To argue that Holly Golightly's fashion choices reflect her status as a successful actress



C: To illustrate the societal norms and expectations for young women during the 1950s



D: To compare and contrast Holly Golightly with other society girls of her time



Question 6 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

31:10

Hide

Annotate  More 

The following text is adapted from Emily Bronte's 1847 novel 'Wuthering Heights'. A servant describes the protagonist, Heathcliff.

He's always, always in my mind: not as a pleasure, any more than I am always a pleasure to myself, but as my own being. His essence is interwoven with the fabric of my soul, an indelible mark that shapes my every thought and action. The very idea of separation is not just painful; it's inconceivable, for he is as much a part of me as the air I breathe. So don't talk of our separation again: it is impracticable; and—' She paused, the enormity of her own words rendering her speechless. Tears filled her eyes, and they fell, one by one, each droplet a silent echo of the deep, unspoken bond that tethered her to him. 'Oh, I will die,' she exclaimed, her voice breaking with the weight of her isolation, 'since no one cares anything about me.'

7  Mark for Review

Which choice best expresses the primary purpose of this passage?

A: To depict the servant's disapproval and frustration towards Heathcliff's persistent presence in her mind

B: To illustrate the protagonist Heathcliff's manipulative nature that makes the servant feel trapped

C: To convey the servant's deep emotional connection with Heathcliff, to the extent that his presence in her thoughts is as integral as her own existence

D: To highlight the servant's fear and despair as she contemplates the inevitability of her own death

Question 7 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:53

Hide

Annotate  More 

Text 1

Alfred Jarry is known for his avant-garde plays, particularly 'Ubu Roi', which broke away from conventional theatrical norms. His work was characterized by absurdism and a unique use of language, which he referred to as 'pataphysics'. This term is used to describe a philosophy that extends beyond metaphysics, dealing with the realm of imaginary solutions and the laws governing exceptions.

Text 2

Literary critic Harold Bloom views Jarry's work as a precursor to the Theatre of the Absurd. He argues that Jarry's 'pataphysics', with its focus on the imaginary and the exceptional, laid the groundwork for later absurdist playwrights. Bloom suggests that Jarry's work pushed boundaries, challenging audiences with its defiance of logical norms and its embrace of the absurd.

8  Mark for Review

Based on the texts, how would Harold Bloom (Text 2) most likely respond to the 'pataphysics' discussed in Text 1?

A: By stating that it is an irrelevant concept that has no bearing on the evolution of theater



B: By asserting that it was instrumental in paving the way for the Theatre of the Absurd by challenging logical norms



C: By suggesting that Jarry's 'pataphysics' was a form of social commentary, intended to critique societal norms



D: By arguing that Jarry's 'pataphysics' was a means of self-expression, rather than a philosophical statement



Question 8 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

In William Wordsworth's poem "I Wandered Lonely as a Cloud," the speaker reflects on the tranquil and joyous experience of viewing a field of daffodils. Referring to the daffodils as "a host, of golden daffodils; / Beside the lake, beneath the trees, / Fluttering and dancing in the breeze," Wordsworth conveys a sense of joyous and tranquil nature.

9  Mark for Review

Which quotation from the poem most effectively illustrates the joyous and tranquil nature that Wordsworth conveys?

A: "For oft, when on my couch I lie / In vacant or in pensive mood, / They flash upon that inward eye / Which is the bliss of solitude"



B: "The waves beside them danced; but they / Out-did the sparkling waves in glee"



C: "Continuous as the stars that shine / And twinkle on the milky way, / They stretched in never-ending line"



D: "Ten thousand saw I at a glance, / Tossing their heads in sprightly dance"



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:40

Hide

Annotate  More 

In Robert Frost's poem "Stopping by Woods on a Snowy Evening," the speaker describes a quiet moment in a snowy forest. Referring to the woods that are "lovely, dark and deep," Frost conveys the sense of serene and tranquil atmosphere of the snowy forest.

10  Mark for Review

Which quotation from the poem most effectively illustrates the atmosphere of the snowy woods?

A: "Whose woods these are I think I know. / His house is in the village though;" 

B: "He gives his harness bells a shake / To ask if there is some mistake." 

C: "The only other sound's the sweep / Of easy wind and downy flake." 

D: "But I have promises to keep, / And miles to go before I sleep." 

Question 10 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:32

Hide

Annotate  More 

Karl Adolph Gjellerup was a Danish author who received the Nobel Prize for Literature in 1917 along with his compatriot Henrik Pontoppidan. Gjellerup's early work was influenced by the aesthetic and ethical ideas of such Danish philosophers as Søren Kierkegaard and Frederik Nietzsche, while his later work reflected his conversion to Buddhism, with its themes of renunciation and compassion. Despite his clear shift in philosophical allegiance, Gjellerup maintained a consistent focus on the human capacity for self-transcendence and the pursuit of higher moral and aesthetic ideals throughout his career.

11  Mark for Review

Which of the following, if true, would most directly challenge the assertion about Gjellerup's consistent focus on human capacity for self-transcendence and the pursuit of higher moral and aesthetic ideals?

A: Gjellerup's works were highly regarded by his contemporaries despite his shift in philosophical allegiance.



B: There are several works in Gjellerup's later period that primarily focus on mundane and worldly concerns, showing little interest in higher moral or aesthetic ideals.



C: Gjellerup's writings, both early and late, were heavily influenced by the socio-political context of his time, rather than philosophical or religious ideas.



D: Many of Gjellerup's works have been translated into multiple languages, expanding his influence beyond Denmark.



Question 11 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:17

Hide

Annotate  More 

Osamu Dazai, a Japanese author, is best known for his novels 'No Longer Human' and 'The Setting Sun'. His works often explore themes of self-destruction, loss, and despair. Despite the melancholy tone, Dazai's works are marked by their poignant, beautiful prose and complex character development. Critics argue that Dazai's personal experiences heavily influence his writing style and themes. They found that his novels contain characters with traits mirroring those of Dazai's, leading to the conclusion that Dazai uses literature as a medium to express his personal struggles.

12  Mark for Review

Which evidence, if true, would most convincingly challenge the critics' assertion about Dazai's work?

A: A comprehensive analysis of Dazai's lesser-known works reveals characters and themes that share no apparent connection with his personal experiences.



B: In one of Dazai's novels, a character experiences a series of events that closely mirrors an episode from Dazai's own life.



C: Several of Dazai's contemporaries also produced works that explored similar themes of despair and self-destruction.



D: Many fans of Dazai's work report feeling a deep connection with his characters, often describing them as 'real' or 'relatable'.



Question 12 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Researcher(s)	Study Year	Warming Scenario	Change in Oxygen Level (%)
Dr. Sylvia Earle	2018	1.5°C warming by 2100	-3.2
Dr. Edith Widder	2020	3°C warming by 2100	-5.1
Dr. Sylvia Earle	2020	2°C warming by 2100	-3.9
Dr. Edith Widder	2018	1.5°C warming by 2100	-3.6

Marine scientists have long observed the impact of ocean warming on the ocean's oxygen levels. As temperatures rise, the solubility of oxygen in seawater decreases, and stratification in the water column reduces the mixing of oxygen-rich surface waters with deeper waters. However, the effect of different ocean warming scenarios on oxygen levels may vary, as suggested by the study of marine biologists Dr. Sylvia Earle and Dr. Edith Widder.

13 Mark for Review

Which choice best describes data from the table that supports Earle and Widder's suggestion?

A: Dr. Sylvia Earle's 2018 study and Dr. Edith Widder's 2020 study both predicted nearly identical decreases in oxygen levels for a 1.5°C warming scenario.

B: Dr. Sylvia Earle's 2020 study shows a change in oxygen level of -3.9%, indicating a greater decrease than her 2018 study.

C: The studies of Dr. Sylvia Earle and Dr. Edith Widder, despite being conducted in different years and involving different warming scenarios, all show a decrease in the ocean's oxygen levels.

D: Dr. Edith Widder's 2020 study predicts a larger decrease in oxygen levels than any other study listed in the table.

Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

30:02

Hide

Annotate  More 

The narrative techniques employed in 20th-century Latin American literature, notably magical realism, allowed authors to weave the ordinary with the fantastical, creating layers of meaning that transcended the literal. This stylistic choice not only blurred the lines between reality and fantasy but also enabled a profound critique of social and political issues without direct confrontation. Magical realism became a lens through which the complexities of Latin American identity, history, and resistance could be explored and understood. This suggests that in the late 20th century, _____

14  Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: authors predominantly focused on the aesthetic qualities of literature, sidelining thematic substance.

B: the genre of magical realism was often misunderstood by critics outside of Latin America.

C: readers were required to have a deep understanding of Latin American history to appreciate these works.

D: magical realism served as a subversive tool to address and reflect upon societal issues.

Question 14 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Elephants have been integral to human strategies for centuries, particularly in warfare. Their strength and size made them formidable opponents on battlefields. In the army of Alexander the Great, elephants were used not just for their physical prowess, but also for their ability to cause fear and confusion among enemy ranks. However, strategists had to grapple with the unpredictable nature of these animals. Despite rigorous training, elephants could panic and stampede, causing havoc among their own troops. Therefore, while their benefits in warfare were significant, their use also presented considerable risk. This led to a strategic reconsideration of their role in warfare, ultimately leading to _____.

15 Mark for Review

Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: an increased reliance on elephants in warfare due to their significant advantages.

B: the invention of new weapons to rival the strength and size of elephants.

C: the gradual phasing out of elephants in warfare due to the associated risks.

D: the development of training programs to ensure absolute control over elephants.

Giovanni da Verrazzano, an Italian explorer, embarked on several voyages in the early 16th century. His most notable journey was the exploration of the Atlantic coast of North America. He was the first European to map the Atlantic seaboard, from Florida to Newfoundland. Despite the dangers and hardships, Verrazzano remained ____ voyages greatly contributed to the understanding of the New World, and his discoveries paved the way for future explorations.

16  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: undeterred, his



B: undeterred his



C: undeterred. His



D: undeterred: his



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:37

Hide

Annotate  More 

The Smithsonian National Air and Space Museum in Washington, D.C., and the Museum of Science and Industry in Chicago are two of many science museums around the world dedicated to displaying historical artifacts _____ inspiring future generations; and educating the public about scientific advancements.

17  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: including aircraft and spacecraft



B: including aircraft and spacecraft;



C: including; aircraft and spacecraft,



D: including, aircraft and spacecraft,



Question 17 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

Solar energy engineering is a field that focuses on harnessing the power of the sun to generate electricity. This is done through the use of solar panels, which convert sunlight into electricity. _____ process is not 100% efficient. A lot of the sunlight that hits the panels is wasted, either because it is not absorbed, or because it is converted into heat instead of electricity. Despite this, solar energy is still a very viable source of renewable energy.

18  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: However this



B: However, this



C: However; this



D: However: this



In many African societies, the baker plays a crucial role. They are not just responsible for baking bread, but also for creating a variety of other food items. The baker's skills are highly valued, and they often serve as a symbol of community and unity. Their work is not only a source of nourishment, but also a means of bringing people together. In this way, _____ to the social and cultural life of the community.

19  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: the baker contributing significantly



B: the baker contributed significantly



C: the baker contributes significantly



D: the baker contribute significantly



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

29:18

Hide

Annotate  More 

In 1858, The Treaty of Amity and Commerce was signed between Japan and the United States. _____ the end of Japan's 220-year-old policy of national seclusion, by opening the ports of Shimoda and Hakodate to American vessels. It also established an American consulate in Japan and provided for the exchange of diplomatic agents.

20

 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: This treaty marks



B: This treaty marked



C: This treaty marking



D: This treaty mark



Question 20 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

African entomology has significantly impacted global insect studies. The continent's diverse insect fauna has provided unique insights into insect biology. _____ to the development of new methods and techniques in insect studies. These methods have been adopted worldwide, enhancing the understanding of insects and their role in ecosystems. The impact of African entomology is therefore profound and far-reaching.

21  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: The research conducted in Africa lead



B: The research conducted in Africa leads



C: The research conducted in Africa leading



D: The research conducted in Africa has led



In a garden, there are dozens of butterfly species, from ones no heavier than a paper clip to those with wingspans as wide as a ruler, that flutter from flower to flower, feeding on nectar and pollinating plants. Colorful patterns on the garden's flowers signal the butterflies' _____.

22 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

A: preferred nectars

B: preferred nectar's

C: preferred nectars'

D: prefers nectar's

The Treaty of Tilsit, signed by Napoleon and Russian Tsar Alexander I in 1807, marked a significant shift in European geopolitics. The treaty was a strategic move by Napoleon to create a buffer against potential British invasions. _____ the treaty had an unexpected impact on Asia. It indirectly led to the rise of British influence in India and the decline of Dutch power in Southeast Asia.

23 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: However,

B: Similarly,

C: Because,

D: For example,

Question 23 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

The Opium Wars were two armed conflicts in the mid-19th century between Western powers and the Qing dynasty of China. The first war (1839–42) was fought between China and Britain, and the second war (1856–60) was fought by Britain and France against China. In each case, the European powers were attempting to open up China to their trade. _____ the wars ended in the Treaty of Tientsin (1858), which opened additional ports in China to foreign trade.

24 Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: On the contrary,

B: In other words,

C: Furthermore,

D: Consequently,

Question 24 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

African entomology has played a substantial role in global insect studies, contributing greatly to our understanding of insect biology and behavior. This increased understanding has led to improved pest management strategies, significantly reducing crop losses in agriculture worldwide. _____, African entomologists have discovered new insect species, enhancing global biodiversity knowledge.

25  Mark for Review

Which choice completes the text with the most logical transition?

A: Nonetheless



B: On the other hand



C: Furthermore



D: However



Section 1, Module 2:
Reading and Writing

Directions ▼

28:40

Hide

Annotate  More 

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- Utilitarianism is a moral theory that proposes actions are right if they benefit the majority.
- The 'greatest happiness principle' is central to utilitarian thought, emphasizing overall well-being.
- Critics argue that utilitarianism can overlook the rights of the minority.
- John Stuart Mill refined utilitarianism to include qualitative distinctions in pleasures.
- Utilitarianism influences debates on policy-making and ethical decision-making in various fields

26  Mark for Review

The student wants to contrast the original utilitarian thought with John Stuart Mill's refinement. Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to accomplish this goal?

A: Utilitarianism, which is applied in policy-making, was refined by John Stuart Mill who proposed the 'greatest happiness principle'.

⌵

B: The ethical decision-making in various fields has been influenced by utilitarianism and its emphasis on the well-being of the majority.

⌵

C: Critics of utilitarianism argue that it can overlook minority rights, but Mill's version still focuses mainly on the overall well-being.

⌵

D: While original utilitarianism focused on the greatest good for the majority, Mill's refinement added a qualitative aspect to the pleasures considered.

⌵

Question 26 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early

While researching a topic, a student has taken the following notes:

- The ancient Greek epics, particularly Homer's 'Iliad' and 'Odyssey', have had a profound influence on modern fantasy literature.
- The 'Iliad' and 'Odyssey' are filled with mythological creatures, gods, and heroes, concepts that are common in modern fantasy.
- J.R.R. Tolkien, the author of 'The Lord of the Rings', was heavily influenced by the 'Odyssey'.
- Many elements in 'The Lord of the Rings', such as the journey narrative and the concept of the 'hero', can be traced back to the 'Odyssey'.
- The 'Odyssey' has also influenced other fantasy works, such as 'Game of Thrones' by George R.R. Martin, who has acknowledged the influence of ancient Greek literature on his work.

27 Mark for Review

Which choice most effectively uses relevant information from the notes to illustrate the impact of the 'Odyssey' on modern fantasy literature?

A: Homer's 'Odyssey', filled with mythological creatures, gods, and heroes, introduced elements like the journey narrative and the concept of the 'hero' found in 'The Lord of the Rings' and other works like 'Game of Thrones'.



B: J.R.R. Tolkien, the celebrated author of 'The Lord of the Rings', drew inspiration from a myriad of sources, including classical epics like Homer's 'Odyssey'.



C: The 'Odyssey' is a popular ancient Greek epic that features mythological creatures, gods, and heroes which is also found in modern fantasy literature.



D: 'Game of Thrones' by George R.R. Martin is a modern fantasy work that contains many elements similar to the 'Odyssey'.



Question 27 of 27 ▼

Back

Next

End module early